Continuous Assessment Brief

Programme/s	Bachelor of Architecture (Honours) - Stage 2 Semester 1	
Year	Year 2	
Module	Publications	
CA No.	2	**% of Module: 35%**
Issue Date	Oct 2026	**Submission Date:** 15 December 2026
Lecturer	Jenny O'Leary Rory Kennedy	**Email: rory.kennedy**@setu.ie
Learning Outcomes Achieved	1. Outline basic design practices used in graphic presentation. 2. Demonstrate introductory level skills in using images and type in creative graphic compositions to communicate visually. 3. Illustrate introductory level skills in page design and layout using publishing industry standard software. 4. Practise & communicate small graphic works.	

Submission Instructions & Rules

Project Brief:

Using the critical analysis skills you have developed during your in-class exercises and other submissions, you are tasked with creating a brochure website suitable for both browser and phone.

You are tasked to create a website that best represents you (as a professional/student) and your work/skills/projects.
"Show us who you are." You have one website. You cannot explain your work verbally. You cannot stand beside your drawings. You cannot explain to the viewer what to look at. The design of the website has to do the communication for you.

You will design a personal architecture portfolio brochure website that communicates: who you are, what you care about, and how you think as an emerging architect. You must create a visual identity that makes your architectural work recognisable, coherent and memorable. The architectural projects are the **content.** Your job is to design the communication system around them. This system should work to a template, and be expandable as you wish to add more content: eg. additional projects.

WEBSITE DELIVERABLES:

1. Website Structure & Content Requirements

Your website must function as a cohesive digital publication. It can be built as a multi-page site or a long-form structured scrolling site with fixed navigation anchors.

The site must include the following 6 core components / pages:

1. **Home (Landing View)**
    - Immediate visual identity establishing who you are as an emerging designer.
    - Clear, persistent navigation menu linking across the entire site.
    - Curated visual preview or index leading directly into your 3 featured projects.
2. **About & Design Manifesto**
    - Profile Statement: A concise statement of your architectural interests and design philosophy (150 to 250 words).
    - Academic Status: Current stage of study (e.g., *Stage 2, Bachelor of Architecture (Honours), SETU*). *(Do not list professional accreditation you have not obtained of yet).*
    - Skills & Proficiencies: CAD/BIM, physical model-making, 3D modelling, Adobe Suite, digital fabrication.
3. **3 Dedicated Portfolio Pages (1 Project Per Page)**
    - **Each project must follow a consistent editorial layout template:**
      Consider including.
        - Project Overview: Title, typology, location, academic semester, brief summary.
        - Context & Concept: Diagrams, site sketches, or conceptual driving ideas.
        - Process & Iteration: Physical study models, iterations, developmental drawings.
        - Resolved Architectural Output: Orthographic drawings (plans, sections, elevations, details) at proper digital legibility, plus atmospheric renderings or finished model photographs.
4. **Contact Page**
    - Institutional email only (@setu.ie or @mail.wit.ie).
    - Student matriculation / ID number.
    - Academic department and campus location (*Department of Architecture, SETU*).
    - Privacy notice: For GDPR and safety reasons, do not publish personal phone numbers or home addresses.

2. Digital Engagement & Interaction (Select Minimum 3)

Use the digital medium opportunities, but not as decorative gimmicks.

Select at least three (3) digital interactions that actively improve how an architectural critic or employer navigates your work:

- Interactive Contact Form: A clean, working input form embedded on your Contact page.
- Interactive Drawing / Model Viewer or Lightbox: A clickable image gallery or modal popup allowing drawings and plans to be inspected at high resolution without pixelation.
- Before-and-After Image Comparison Slider: A split-screen slider comparing a design iteration to a final scheme, a site photo to a proposed elevation, or a structural diagram to an inhabited render.
- Subtle Micro-Interactions / Navigation Motion: Hover states on project thumbnails, smooth-scroll anchor links, or clean drawer menus that aid navigation clarity.
- Print-to-Digital Bridge (QR Code Utility): A QR code provided on your Contact/About page designed specifically for placement on your printed CV or studio presentation boards, linking a physical reviewer directly back to this live site or to a downloadable publication PDF.
- Embedded External Media: An embedded video walkthrough, animated GIF diagram of structural assembly/circulation, or embedded flipbook/PDF document.

Consider the following:

- Think about who your website is aimed at.
- What atmosphere and tone of voice should the website take? What does it express about you and what you wish to convey?
- What colour(s) will evoke the tone you wish to express? What influence does the colour have on the content and the reader?
- Consider the font type, how many fonts are you using, and what do they express?
- How to ensure your content grabs the user's attention and is easily accessible.

Preparation & process:
Use the following steps to prepare your work. Record these steps, and submit a document recording this process as part of the assignment.

01 — RESEARCH

Before designing anything, investigate how designers, architects, artists and creative studios communicate themselves.

Create a visual research board containing **10–15 reference websites**.
For each reference, identify at least one design decision:

- Typography
- Grid
- Colour
- Image treatment
- Scale
- Composition
- Navigation
- Motion
- White space
- Hierarchy
- Editorial style

Then identify **three visual directions** that could inform your own portfolio.

02 — DEFINE YOUR VISUAL POSITION

Complete the following:

I am interested in:

My work is influenced by:

Three words I want my portfolio to communicate:
_____ / _____ / _____

My portfolio should feel:

03 — DEVELOP A VISUAL CONCEPT

Your portfolio would benefit from a **central graphic idea**.

This could be based on:

- A grid
- A material
- A colour
- A typeface
- A drawing technique
- A geometric system
- A spatial concept
- A personal interest
- A recurring architectural idea

Avoid designing a collection of unrelated visual effects. You are developing a **system**.

04 — TYPOGRAPHY

Typography will be one of the primary tools through which your identity is communicated.

Experiment with:

- Serif / sans serif
- Display / body type
- Scale
- Weight
- Kerning & Tracking
- Leading
- Alignment
- Capitalisation
- Vertical text
- Oversized typography
- Typographic hierarchy

Develop a type system containing:

H1 — Project Titles

H2 — Section Titles

Body — Project Descriptions

Caption — Drawing / Image Information

Navigation — Interface

You should be able to explain **why you selected your typefaces**.

05 — THE GRID

Develop a graphic grid for your website.

Experiment with:

- Columns
- Margins
- Gutters
- Baseline
- Image proportions
- Text blocks
- Alignment
- Asymmetry
- Full-bleed images

The grid should create consistency without making every page identical.

When should the grid be followed — and when should it be broken?

06 — COLOUR

Develop a colour strategy.

Your palette might be:

- Monochrome
- Neutral
- Material-inspired
- Highly saturated
- Architectural
- Natural
- Experimental

Consider whether colour should:

- Identify projects
- Identify sections
- Highlight information
- Create hierarchy
- Establish atmosphere
- Remain almost invisible

Produce a **colour palette** containing:

- Primary colour
- Secondary colour
- Background
- Text
- Accent

Deliverables:

1. A record of the process of designing your website. This document will contain the reflections and process work as per the tasks/prompts above.
2. PDF of the template layout of the Portfolio Page (1 finished example)
3. A link to a fully designed and functioning personal portfolio website (offline). It should contain the following pages and functionality:
   Structure/Navigation and user interactions as above

4. Submission of high quality PDF of all pages of website.

There will be an in-person demonstration of the website, with full functionality.

For this exercise you are permitted **to use the following website building tools**:
https://www.squarespace.com/
https://wordpress.com/
https://www.canva.com/help/canva-websites/ (login also available via SETU)

References:

Animated websites, using transitions, scrolling, animations:
Herzog & De Meuron https://www.herzogdemeuron.com/
Telha Clarke https://telhaclarke.com.au/
By Bang https://bybang.co/
OMA: https://www.oma.com/
See more here:
https://www.awwwards.com/awwwards/collections/css-js-animations/

https://embedsocial.com/blog/widgets-for-websites/

Wordpress and Squarespace sites:
https://structureengineering.com.au/
https://onseis.com/
https://www.itsfoke.com/
https://www.zendaya.com/
See more here:
https://www.awwwards.com/websites/wordpress/

For this exercise avoid complex websites, with difficult navigation, eg.
De Vilder Vynck Architects: https://architectenjdviv.com/
Clancy Moore Architects https://www.clancymoore.com/

Dabner, D., S. Stewart and E. Zempol. Graphic Design School: A Foundation Course for Graphic Designers Working in Print, Moving Image and Digital Media.. New Jersey: John Wiley & Sons, 2014.

Software for building websites:
Wordpress: https://wordpress.com/
Squarespace: https://www.squarespace.com/

SETU have access to Canva software for website building:
Video available here to walk people through logging in. This uses the following steps:

1. Go to Canva.com.
2. Click Log in.
3. Click Continue another way.
4. Click Continue with work email.
5. Enter your SETU email ONLY.
6. Click Log in with SSO.
7. Once you have entered your login details, you should have access to Canva

All issues related to Canva Accounts should be sent to John Fortune (john.fortune@setu.ie)

Learning Outcomes:

1. Demonstrate introductory level skills in using images and type in creative graphic compositions to communicate visually.
2. Illustrate introductory level skills in page design and layout using publishing industry standard software.
3. Practise & communicate small graphic works.

Assessment Criteria:

- 70% - 100%: The learner has: attained the module learning outcomes at an excellent level; demonstrated a comprehensive knowledge of the associated subject matter; achieved an excellent level of the skills required for the subject matter; demonstrated the ability to carry out further investigation and problem solving associated with the subject matter.
- 60% - 69%: The learner has: attained the module learning outcomes at a very good level; demonstrated a detailed knowledge of the associated subject matter; achieved a very good level of the skills required for the subject matter.
- 50% - 59%: The learner has: attained the module learning outcomes at a good level; demonstrated a good knowledge of the associated subject matter; achieved a good level of the skills required for the subject matter.
- 40% - 49%: The learner has: attained the module learning outcomes at a basic level; demonstrated a basic knowledge of the associated subject matter; achieved a basic level of the skills required for the subject matter.
- < 40%: The learner has not: attained the module learning outcomes; demonstrated sufficient knowledge of the associated subject matter; demonstrated a sufficient level of the skills required for the subject matter.

Notes:

07 — IMAGE DIRECTION

Your portfolio will contain a large amount of visual material.
You must develop a consistent approach to:

Photography
How are photographs cropped?
Drawings
How are plans and sections presented?
Renders
Are they full-screen or contained?
Diagrams
How are they integrated?
Models
Are photographs documentary or atmospheric?
Sketches
Are they presented as evidence of process?

IMAGE EXERCISE
Take one project and create **three completely different graphic presentations**.
Option A
Editorial
Option B
Technical
Option C
Experimental
Compare them.

Which one communicates the project most effectively?

Why?

08 — DESIGN THE PORTFOLIO SYSTEM

Now bring your graphic decisions together.
Create a **mini design system**.

Your system should establish:

Typography
Typeface + hierarchy
Grid

Columns + margins + spacing

Colour

Primary + secondary + accent

Image

Cropping + scale + placement

Graphic elements

Lines, shapes, symbols, icons or other devices

Navigation

Menus + links + page transitions

Language

Tone of project descriptions and headings

09 — DESIGN THE WEBSITE

The website becomes the final application of your graphic system.
You should design at least:

HOME

Your visual introduction.

ABOUT

Your identity and personal statement.

PROJECT INDEX

A clear overview of your work.

PROJECT PAGE

A complete graphic system for presenting one architectural project.

CV

A visually coherent representation of your experience.

CONTACT

A clear and simple conclusion.

10 — DESIGN THE HOMEPAGE

The homepage should work like the cover of a publication.
It should immediately establish:

WHO?

Who are you?

WHAT?

What do you do?

WHY?

What do you care about?

The homepage should not try to show everything.

Design a strong first impression.

11 — DESIGN ONE PROJECT AS AN EDITORIAL

Choose one architectural project.
Treat it as if you were designing a magazine feature.

Create a sequence:

COVER
Title + image
↓

INTRODUCTION
Short project statement
↓

CONTEXT
Site / location / research
↓

PROCESS
Sketches / diagrams / models
↓

DEVELOPMENT
Iterations / decisions
↓

FINAL
Drawings / images / photographs
↓

REFLECTION
What was learned?
This sequence becomes the template for the other projects.

12 — INFORMATION HIERARCHY

Not everything on the page has equal importance.
Create clear levels of information.

LEVEL 01
What should I see first?
LEVEL 02
What should I understand next?
LEVEL 03
What additional information can I discover?
Use:

- Scale

- Position
- Contrast
- Colour
- Typography
- White space
- Image size

to create hierarchy.

13 — THE 5-SECOND TEST

Show your homepage to someone for **5 seconds**.
Hide it.

Ask:

What do you remember?
If they remember nothing, redesign it.
If they remember the visual identity, you are developing a recognisable system.

If they remember your architectural interests, you are communicating successfully.

14 — THE BLACK-AND-WHITE TEST

Remove all colour.
Does the website still work?

If yes, your hierarchy is probably doing its job.

If no, investigate whether colour is doing too much of the communication.

15 — THE TYPE TEST

Remove the images.
Leave only:

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